VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION




# Social Studies

GRADE 4

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

VENVLEARNING

# Grade 4
# Social Studies

TEACHER EDITION

2026–2027 School Year

**Unit 1** Mississippi: Land and Regions

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

# How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Warm-Up 5 · Read and Discuss 15 · Analyze 10 · Guided Practice 7 · Independent 10 · Exit Ticket 3.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Tuesday and Thursday are lessons. Friday is the Weekly Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Dates match the VenvLearning lesson plans for the 2026–2027 school year.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

# Mississippi: Land and Regions

Map skills, location, landforms and rivers, natural regions, resources, and regional economies.

From the flat, fertile Delta to the pine forests and the Gulf Coast, Mississippi is a state of many landscapes. In this unit you'll learn to read maps like a geographer, find Mississippi's place in the world, explore its rivers and regions, and discover how its natural resources shape the way people live and work.

## Big ideas

- Read maps using the title, compass rose, key, and scale.
- Describe Mississippi's relative and absolute location.
- Identify landforms, waterways, and natural regions.
- Classify natural resources and explain how they shape regional economies.

## Standards

| Code | Standard |
|---|---|
| C3 D2.Geo.1–4 | Maps; places and regions; human–environment interaction. |
| C3 D2.Eco.3 | Resources used to produce goods and services. |

## What students should already know

- Cardinal directions.

## Materials for the unit

- Globe or world map
- Mississippi road map (optional)
- Salt dough materials
- Index cards, poster paper

## Pacing calendar

| Week | Day | Lesson | Title |
|---|---|---|---|
| Week of Oct 26 | Tue 10/27 | 1.1 | Maps and Globes |
| Week of Oct 26 | Thu 10/29 | 1.2 | Where in the World Is Mississippi? |
| Week of Oct 26 | Fri 10/30 | Check | Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location |
| Week of Nov 2 | Tue 11/3 | 1.3 | Mississippi's Land and Water |
| Week of Nov 2 | Thu 11/5 | 1.4 | Reading Physical and Political Maps |
| Week of Nov 2 | Fri 11/6 | Check | Weekly Check 2: Land and Water |
| Week of Nov 9 | Tue 11/10 | 1.5 | Mississippi's Natural Regions |
| Week of Nov 9 | Thu 11/12 | 1.6 | Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods |
| Week of Nov 9 | Fri 11/13 | Check | Weekly Check 3: Regions |
| Week of Nov 16 | Tue 11/17 | 1.7 | Natural Resources |
| Week of Nov 16 | Thu 11/19 | 1.8 | Resources and Work in Each Region |
| Week of Nov 16 | Fri 11/20 | Test | Unit 1 Test |

### TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

On your next drive, look at a map together before you leave and track your route, directions, and the rivers you cross.

### UNIT VOCABULARY

| | |
|---|---|
| compass rose | Shows directions on a map. |
| latitude | Lines measuring distance north or south of the equator. |
| region | An area with shared features. |
| natural resource | Something from nature people use. |
| goods | Things made or grown to sell. |
| services | Work done for others. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 · Tue Oct 27

# Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

*I can use a map's title, compass rose, key, and scale to read a map.*

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students use map parts to read a map. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other representations of familiar places. |
| Date | Tue Oct 27 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Workbook Lesson 1.1, paper, ruler, colored pencils |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Directions to a park. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson and the Mississippi map. |
| Analyze | 10 | Model each map part.<br>Measure Jackson to Gulfport with the scale. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Assuming north is always “up” on every map without checking the compass rose.

SUPPORT

- Map-part sticky labels.

EXTEND

- Map your neighborhood.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

THINK ABOUT IT

If you had to give a friend directions from your house to a park, what would you draw?

A globe is a model of Earth, so it shows shapes and distances correctly, but it's hard to carry and you can only see half at a time. A map is a flat drawing of a place. Maps can show a whole country or one small neighborhood.

| Map part | What it tells you |
|---|---|
| title | what the map shows |
| compass rose | directions: north (N), south (S), east (E), west (W), and in-between directions like northeast (NE) |
| map key (legend) | what each symbol, line, or color means |
| scale | how far apart places really are |

This map's title tells you it shows cities of Mississippi. The star marks Jackson, the state capital, and dots mark other cities.

The compass rose in the top corner points north. The scale bar at the bottom stands for 50 miles. Rivers are drawn in blue.

Notice that the Mississippi River traces most of the state's western edge, and the southern coast meets the Gulf of Mexico.

Cities of Mississippi




LOOK CLOSER · USE THE SCALE

About how far is it from Jackson to Gulfport?

1 Measure the distance on the map with a strip of paper.
2 Compare it with the scale bar (50 miles).
3 The distance is about three scale bars long.

Answer: about 150 miles

ACTIVITY · MAP MY ROOM

Can you make a map someone else could use?

You need: paper; ruler; colored pencils.

1 Draw your bedroom or kitchen as if you were looking down from the ceiling.
2 Add a title and a compass rose (find north with a compass app or the sunrise in the east).
3 Make a key with at least four symbols.
4 Add a scale such as "1 inch = 2 feet."

Record: your finished map; trade with a family member and ask them to find something using only the map.

KEY IDEA

Read the title, check the compass rose, use the key, and measure with the scale.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Which map part explains symbols?

Answer: the map key (legend)

2. Which direction is between north and east?

Answer: northeast

3. Which city is the state capital?

Answer: Jackson

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | The four cardinal directions | north, south, east, west |
| 2 | A round model of Earth | globe |
| 3 | Use the map for questions 3–7. Which city is farthest north? (figure) | Southaven |
| 4 | Which two cities are on the Gulf of Mexico? | Gulfport and Biloxi |
| 5 | In which direction would you travel from Jackson to Meridian? | east |

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 6 | In which direction from Tupelo is Hattiesburg? | south (slightly southwest) |
| 7 | Which river forms Mississippi's western border? | the Mississippi River |
| 8 | Name the four map parts and tell what each one does. | Title: what the map shows; compass rose: directions; key: symbols; scale: distance. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 · Thu Oct 29

# Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

***I can describe Mississippi's location using relative location, hemispheres, and latitude and longitude.***

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students describe relative and absolute location. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between locations of places. |
| Date | Thu Oct 29 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Globe or world map, workbook Lesson 1.2 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Describe home to someone far away. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson; examine both maps. |
| Analyze | 10 | Teach latitude/longitude and hemispheres. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook. Weekly Check Friday. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Mixing up latitude and longitude.

SUPPORT

- "Lat is flat" memory trick.

EXTEND

- Find the coordinates of a favorite vacation spot.

STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

THINK ABOUT IT

How would you describe where you live to someone on the other side of the world?

Relative location describes a place by what is near it. Mississippi is in the southern United States. It borders Tennessee to the north, Alabama to the east, the Gulf of Mexico and Louisiana to the south, and Louisiana and Arkansas to the west, across the Mississippi River.




Mississippi is highlighted.

Absolute location uses a grid of imaginary lines. Lines of latitude measure degrees north or south of the equator. Lines of longitude measure degrees east or west of the prime meridian.

Because Mississippi is north of the equator and west of the prime meridian, it is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres. Jackson is at about 32° N, 90° W.



Latitude labels at left; longitude labels at bottom.

ACTIVITY · GRID HUNT

Can you find places using latitude and longitude?

You need: a globe or world map with latitude and longitude lines; notebook.

1. Find 30° N, 90° W. What place is near there?
2. Find the equator and the prime meridian.
3. Find a place in each of the four hemispheres.
4. Make up two coordinates and challenge a family member to find them.

Record: each coordinate and the place you found.

KEY IDEA

Relative location compares places; absolute location uses latitude and longitude. Mississippi is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Which state borders Mississippi to the east?

Answer: Alabama

2. Which body of water is south of Mississippi?

Answer: the Gulf of Mexico

3. Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?

Answer: Northern and Western

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Lines that run east–west | latitude |
| 2 | Half of Earth is a... | hemisphere |
| 3 | State north of Mississippi | Tennessee |
| 4 | Two states west of Mississippi | Louisiana and Arkansas |
| 5 | Jackson's approximate latitude | 32° N |
| 6 | Is Mississippi north or south of the equator? | north |
| 7 | Relative or absolute: "Jackson is about 32° N, 90° W." | absolute |
| 8 | Relative or absolute: "Gulfport is on the Gulf of Mexico." | relative |
| 9 | Describe Mississippi's relative location in two sentences. | e.g. Mississippi is in the southern U.S. between Louisiana and Alabama, with Tennessee to the north and the Gulf of Mexico to the south. |

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 30

# Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location — Answer Key

## Answers

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Which map part shows directions? | compass rose |
| 2 | Which map part explains symbols? | map key (legend) |
| 3 | What does a scale show? | real distance |
| 4 | Which state is east of Mississippi? | Alabama |
| 5 | Which hemispheres is Mississippi in? | Northern and Western |
| 6 | Relative or absolute: “32° N, 90° W” | absolute |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 · Tue Nov 3

# Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

***I can identify Mississippi's major landforms and waterways and explain why they matter.***

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students identify landforms and waterways. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between places and environmental characteristics. |
| Date | Tue Nov 3 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Tray, towel, water, pebbles, workbook Lesson 1.3 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Rivers flow south. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson; trace rivers on the map. |
| Analyze | 10 | Discuss elevation and flow; waterways and trade. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking rivers always flow “down” the map (south) everywhere.

SUPPORT

- Highlight each river a different color.

EXTEND

- Research a Mississippi river's source.

STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

THINK ABOUT IT

Most of Mississippi's rivers flow toward the south. Why do you think that is?

Mississippi is mostly low, rolling hills and flat plains. Its highest point is Woodall Mountain in the far northeast, about 806 feet above sea level. Its lowest point is sea level along the Gulf of Mexico. Because the land is generally higher in the north and lower in the south, most rivers flow south toward the Gulf.

| Waterway | Fact |
|---|---|
| Mississippi River | Forms most of the state's western border; one of the longest rivers in North America |
| Yazoo River | Flows through the Delta into the Mississippi at Vicksburg |
| Pearl River | Flows past Jackson to the Gulf; part of it forms the border with Louisiana |
| Tombigbee River | Flows south through eastern Mississippi into Alabama |
| Pascagoula River | Flows into the Gulf at Pascagoula |
| Gulf of Mexico | Mississippi's southern coast, about 44 miles long |

Waterways have always mattered to people here. Rivers provided fish, water, and travel routes for American Indian nations.

Later, steamboats carried cotton and goods on the Mississippi River.

Today, barges still move goods on the Mississippi and on the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway, a canal system opened in 1985 that connects the Tennessee River to the Tombigbee.




ACTIVITY · WHICH WAY DOES WATER FLOW?

How does the slope of land decide where rivers go?

You need: a baking sheet or tray; a towel to tilt it; a cup of water; a few pebbles.

1 Raise one end of the tray to make “high land” in the north.

2 Slowly pour water at the high end.

3 Watch which way it flows and where it collects.

4 Add pebbles as “hills” and observe how the water's path changes.

Record: a sketch showing high land, low land, and the water's path, and an explanation linked to Mississippi's rivers.

KEY IDEA

Mississippi's land is higher in the north and lower in the south, so most rivers flow south to the Gulf. Rivers have shaped travel, trade, and settlement.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What is Mississippi's highest point?

Answer: Woodall Mountain (about 806 feet)

2. Which river forms most of the western border?

Answer: the Mississippi River

3. Why do most rivers flow south?

Answer: The land is higher in the north and lower in the south.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | A large area of flat land | plain |
| 2 | A smaller river that flows into a larger one | tributary |
| 3 | Which river flows past Jackson? | the Pearl River |
| 4 | Where does the Yazoo River join the Mississippi? | at Vicksburg |
| 5 | What canal system connects the Tennessee and Tombigbee rivers? | the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway |
| 6 | What is Mississippi's lowest elevation? | sea level |
| 7 | Explain two ways rivers have been important to people in Mississippi. | e.g. fish and water; travel and trade by boat and barge. |
| 8 | Use the tray investigation to explain why the Pearl River flows to the Gulf. | Water flows downhill; the land slopes down toward the Gulf in the south. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 · Thu Nov 5

# Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

*I can tell physical and political maps apart and use each to answer questions.*

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students compare physical and political maps. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other graphic representations. |
| Date | Thu Nov 5 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Salt dough materials, workbook Lesson 1.4 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Rivers vs cities. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson; compare the maps. |
| Analyze | 10 | Model using two maps together. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook. Weekly Check Friday. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking one map shows everything.

SUPPORT

- Sort questions into physical/political.

EXTEND

- Find your county on a Mississippi county map.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

THINK ABOUT IT

What's the difference between a map of the rivers in Mississippi and a map of its cities?

A physical map shows what nature made: rivers, hills, coastlines, and elevation, often with colors (green for low land, tan or brown for higher land). A political map shows what people decided: state and county boundaries, capitals, and cities. Mississippi is divided into 82 counties.

| Question | Better map |
|---|---|
| Where is the state capital? | political |
| Where is the land highest? | physical |
| Which county is Tupelo in? | political |
| Which way does the Pearl River flow? | physical |

LOOK CLOSER · USE TWO MAPS TOGETHER

Why did cities like Vicksburg and Natchez grow where they did?

1 Physical map: both sit on high bluffs beside the Mississippi River.

2 Political map: both are cities in western Mississippi.

3 Put them together: the high bluffs were safe from floods, and the river brought trade.

Answer: They grew on bluffs above the river, where people could trade by boat but stay above floodwaters.

ACTIVITY · SALT DOUGH RELIEF MAP

Can you build a physical map of Mississippi?

You need: outline of Mississippi traced on cardboard; salt dough (2 cups flour, 1 cup salt, about 3/4 cup water); paint; toothpick flags.

1 Spread a thin layer of dough over the outline.

2 Build it a little higher in the northeast and keep the Delta and coast flat.

3 Press a groove for the Mississippi and Pearl rivers.

4 When dry, paint low land green and higher land tan, and add flags for Jackson and your town.

Record: a photo or sketch of your map with a key.

KEY IDEA

Physical maps show natural features; political maps show boundaries and cities. Using both explains why places are where they are.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Which kind of map shows county lines?

Answer: political

2. Which kind shows elevation?

Answer: physical

3. How many counties does Mississippi have?

Answer: 82

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Height above sea level | elevation |
| 2 | Map that shows cities | political map |
| 3 | Find the route of the Yazoo River. Which map? | physical |
| 4 | Find the boundary between Mississippi and Alabama. Which map? | political |
| 5 | Find the flattest region. Which map? | physical |
| 6 | Find the nearest city to your home. Which map? | political |
| 7 | Why might a city grow on a bluff next to a river? | Safe from floods but close to the river for water and trade. |
| 8 | Write one question a physical map can answer and one a political map can answer. | Answers vary. |

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Nov 6

# Weekly Check 2: Land and Water — Answer Key

## Answers

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mississippi's highest point | Woodall Mountain |
| 2 | River on the western border | Mississippi River |
| 3 | River that flows past Jackson | Pearl River |
| 4 | Map that shows elevation | physical |
| 5 | Map that shows county lines | political |
| 6 | Why do most Mississippi rivers flow south? | The land is higher in the north and slopes down to the Gulf. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 · Tue Nov 10

# Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

*I can identify Mississippi's natural regions and describe the land in each.*

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students identify Mississippi's natural regions. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Explain relationships between locations of places and regions and their environmental characteristics. |
| Date | Tue Nov 10 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Index cards, workbook Lesson 1.5 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Road trip changes. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson; locate regions on the map. |
| Analyze | 10 | Discuss each region's land and soil. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking regions have sharp borders.

SUPPORT

- Color-coded region chart.

EXTEND

- Find photos of each region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

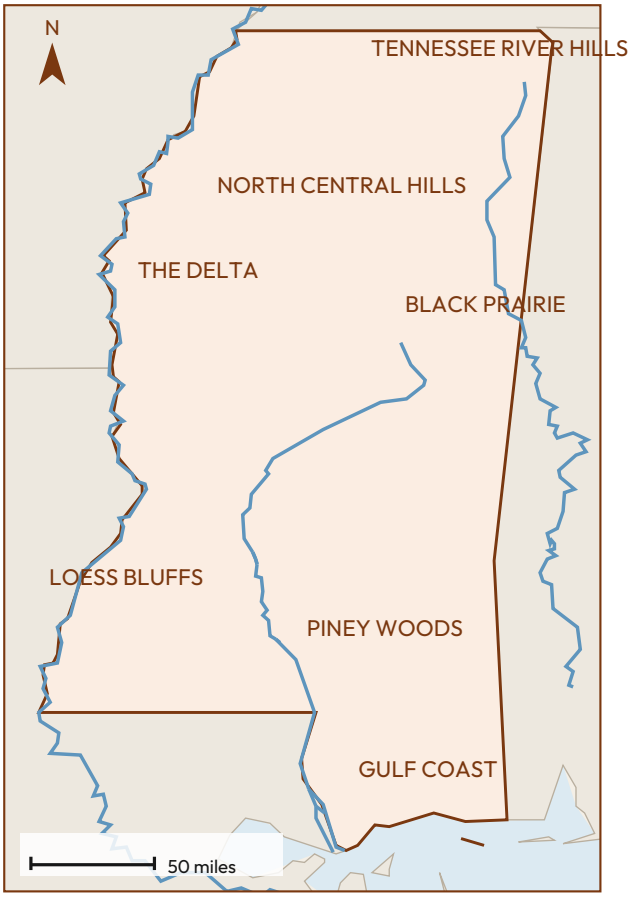
THINK ABOUT IT

If you drove from Tupelo to Greenville to Gulfport, how might the land outside your window change?

Geographers divide Mississippi into natural regions by land, soil, and plants.

Regions don't have sharp edges; one blends into the next. The labels on the map show where each region generally is.

As you read the chart below, find each region on the map.




General locations of Mississippi's natural regions.

| Region | What the land is like |
|---|---|
| The Delta | very flat, fertile alluvial soil left by Mississippi and Yazoo river floods; northwest |
| Loess Bluffs | steep bluffs of fine wind-blown soil along the east edge of the Mississippi River valley |
| North Central Hills | rolling hills with red clay soil |
| Tennessee River Hills | the highest, most rugged land, in the far northeast |
| Black Prairie | gently rolling land with dark, rich soil in the northeast |
| Piney Woods | rolling hills with sandy soil and pine forests in the south |
| Gulf Coast | low, flat land with beaches, marshes, and bays along the Gulf of Mexico |

ACTIVITY · REGION POSTCARDS

What would you see in each region?

You need: index cards; colored pencils.

1 Choose three regions.

2 On each card, draw a scene showing the land, plants, and one way people use the land.

3 On the back, write a short message describing the region to a friend.

Record: three postcards with accurate details.

KEY IDEA

Mississippi's regions include the Delta, Loess Bluffs, the hills, the Black Prairie, the Piney Woods, and the Gulf Coast, each with its own land and soil.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Which region is flattest and most fertile?

Answer: the Delta

2. Which region has pine forests?

Answer: the Piney Woods

3. Which region has the highest land?

Answer: the Tennessee River Hills

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Region = | an area with shared features |
| 2 | Soil left by rivers is... | alluvial |
| 3 | beaches and marshes | Gulf Coast |
| 4 | dark, rich soil in the northeast | Black Prairie |
| 5 | wind-blown soil bluffs | Loess Bluffs |
| 6 | red clay hills | North Central Hills |
| 7 | flat land between two rivers | the Delta |
| 8 | sandy soil and pines | Piney Woods |
| 9 | Which region do you live in or nearest to? Describe its land. | Answers vary. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · C3 D2.Geo.4.3-5 · Thu Nov 12

# Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

***I can compare two regions and explain how land affects the way people live and work.***

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students compare two regions. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Explain how people modify and adapt to their environments. |
| Date | Thu Nov 12 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Workbook Lesson 1.6 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Delta farm vs Piney Woods town. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read both descriptions. |
| Analyze | 10 | Model one Venn entry each. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook. Weekly Check Friday. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Listing facts without comparing.

SUPPORT

- Compare/contrast word bank.

EXTEND

- Interview a relative who lived in another region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

THINK ABOUT IT

How might growing up on a Delta farm be different from growing up in a Piney Woods town?

The Delta is a broad, flat plain in northwestern Mississippi between the Mississippi and Yazoo rivers. For thousands of years, floods left layers of rich soil. Today the Delta is known for large farms of cotton, soybeans, corn, and rice, and for catfish farming in ponds. Towns are spread out across wide fields. The Delta is also famous as a birthplace of the blues.

The Piney Woods covers much of southeastern Mississippi. Its sandy soil is less fertile for crops, but it is excellent for growing pine trees. Lumber and paper mills grew up around cities such as Hattiesburg and Laurel. Forests here also support hunting, outdoor recreation, and wildlife.

| | The Delta | Piney Woods | Both |
|---|---|---|---|
| land | very flat | rolling hills | part of Mississippi; rivers |
| soil | rich alluvial soil | sandy soil | |
| main uses | row crops, catfish farms | timber, paper, outdoor recreation | agriculture is important |
| places | Greenville, Clarksdale | Hattiesburg, Laurel | |

ACTIVITY · VENN DIAGRAM

How are the two regions alike and different?

You need: paper; two colored pencils.

1. Draw two overlapping circles labeled Delta and Piney Woods.
2. Write at least four details in each outer part.
3. Write at least two shared details in the middle.
4. Write a summary sentence.

Record: your Venn diagram and summary.

KEY IDEA

The land and soil of a region shape how people earn a living there.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Why is the Delta good for crops?

Answer: Floods left rich alluvial soil on flat land.

2. What grows well in the Piney Woods?

Answer: pine trees (timber)

3. Name a Piney Woods city.

Answer: Hattiesburg or Laurel

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | To tell how things differ | contrast |
| 2 | Trees cut for wood | timber |
| 3 | Delta land shape | flat |
| 4 | Piney Woods soil | sandy |
| 5 | One Delta product | cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, or catfish |
| 6 | One Piney Woods product | lumber or paper |
| 7 | Write a paragraph comparing the two regions. Use a compare word (both, similarly) and a contrast word (however, but). | Answers vary; include land, soil, and work. |
| 8 | Explain how soil affects the jobs people have in each region. | Rich Delta soil supports crops; sandy Piney Woods soil supports pine forests and timber. |

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Nov 13

# Weekly Check 3: Regions — Answer Key

## Answers

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Flat region with rich river soil | the Delta |
| 2 | Region with sandy soil and pine forests | Piney Woods |
| 3 | Region with beaches and marshes | Gulf Coast |
| 4 | Region with dark, rich soil in the northeast | Black Prairie |
| 5 | Name one way the Delta and Piney Woods are alike and one way they are different. | Alike: both are Mississippi regions where natural resources support work. Different: Delta is flat with rich soil for crops; Piney Woods has sandy soil and pine forests. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5 · Tue Nov 17

# Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

***I can identify Mississippi's natural resources and classify them as renewable or nonrenewable.***

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students classify natural resources. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services. |
| Date | Tue Nov 17 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Workbook Lesson 1.7 |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Room scan. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson and table. |
| Analyze | 10 | Model classifying resources. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking renewable means unlimited.

SUPPORT

- Picture sort.

EXTEND

- Visit a recycling center or tree farm.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

THINK ABOUT IT

Look around the room. What came from nature: from soil, trees, water, or underground?

Mississippi is rich in natural resources. Some are renewable: forests can be replanted, and fish and farm crops can grow again if they are managed well. Others are nonrenewable: oil and natural gas, found underground in parts of southern Mississippi and offshore in the Gulf, took millions of years to form.

| Resource | Renewable? | Used for |
|---|---|---|
| fertile soil | renewable if cared for | growing crops |
| forests | renewable (replanting) | lumber, paper, furniture |
| water (rivers, groundwater) | renewable | drinking, farming, fishing, transportation |
| fish and shellfish (Gulf) | renewable if not overfished | food |
| oil and natural gas | nonrenewable | fuel, energy |
| sand, gravel, and clay | nonrenewable | building roads and bricks |

Conservation helps resources last. Foresters replant trees after harvests, farmers protect soil from erosion, and fishing seasons and limits help keep Gulf fish and shrimp populations healthy.

ACTIVITY · RESOURCE HUNT

Where do the things in your home come from?

You need: notebook.

1. Find ten objects in your home.
2. For each, name the natural resource it came from (wood, cotton, oil/plastic, metal, sand/glass).
3. Label each resource renewable or nonrenewable.
4. Circle one item you could reuse or recycle.

Record: a three-column chart: Object | Natural resource | Renewable or nonrenewable.

KEY IDEA

Natural resources come from nature. Renewable resources can be replaced; nonrenewable ones cannot. Conservation helps them last.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Is a pine forest renewable or nonrenewable?

Answer: renewable

2. Is natural gas renewable?

Answer: no, nonrenewable

3. Name one way to conserve a resource.

Answer: e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Something from nature people use | natural resource |
| 2 | Careful use of resources | conservation |
| 3 | cotton | renewable |
| 4 | oil | nonrenewable |
| 5 | shrimp | renewable (if managed) |
| 6 | gravel | nonrenewable |
| 7 | water | renewable |
| 8 | timber | renewable |
| 9 | Choose one Mississippi resource. Explain how people use it and one way to conserve it. | Answers vary. |
| 10 | Why is it important to conserve even renewable resources? | They can run out if used faster than they are replaced. |

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5, D2.Geo.4.3-5 · Thu Nov 19

# Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

***I can explain how natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in different regions.***

| | |
|---|---|
| Objective | Students connect resources to regional economies. |
| Standard | C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5, D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services; how people adapt to environments. |
| Date | Thu Nov 19 |
| Time | About 50 minutes |
| Materials | Poster paper, markers, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review |
| Get ready | Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions. |

## Lesson Flow

| Part | Min | What to do and say |
|---|---|---|
| Warm-Up | 5 | Three workers. |
| Read and Discuss | 15 | Read the lesson and table. |
| Analyze | 10 | Model tracing a product. |
| Guided Practice | 7 | Check Your Understanding 1–3. |
| Independent | 10 | Workbook; then the Unit 1 Review. |
| Exit Ticket | 3 | Tomorrow (Friday): Unit 1 Test. |

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Confusing goods and services.

SUPPORT

- Goods = hold it; services = someone does it.

EXTEND

- Visit a local farm, mill, or port online.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

# Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

THINK ABOUT IT

A Delta farmer, a Piney Woods mill worker, and a Gulf Coast shrimper all earn a living. What does each one depend on?

The economy of each region grows from its resources. Farmers grow goods in fertile soil. Mill workers turn trees into lumber and paper. Gulf Coast workers catch seafood, build ships, and serve visitors. Agriculture is Mississippi's largest industry, and chickens raised for meat (broilers) are among its most valuable farm products.

| Region | Key resources | Goods and services |
|---|---|---|
| The Delta | rich soil, water | cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, farm-raised catfish |
| Piney Woods | pine forests | lumber, paper, wood products |
| Black Prairie and hills | soil, pasture | cattle, poultry, crops, manufacturing |
| Gulf Coast | the Gulf, beaches, ports | seafood, shipbuilding, shipping, tourism |

LOOK CLOSER · TRACE A PRODUCT

A pine tree becomes a notebook

1 Natural resource: a pine tree grows in the Piney Woods.

2 Producers: loggers harvest it; a paper mill turns it into paper.

3 Services: truck drivers deliver it; a store sells it.

4 Consumer: you buy the notebook.

Answer: One resource creates many jobs on its way to you.

ACTIVITY · REGIONAL ECONOMY POSTER

How does one region earn a living?

You need: poster paper; markers.

1 Choose one region.

2 Show its resources, two goods or services, and two jobs.

3 Draw arrows from each resource to the goods it produces.

4 Present your poster to your family.

Record: your poster and a two-sentence summary.

KEY IDEA

Natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in each region.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Goods or service: a haircut

Answer: service

2. Goods or service: a bag of rice

Answer: goods

3. Which region is known for shipbuilding and seafood?

Answer: the Gulf Coast

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

## Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Things made or grown to sell | goods |
| 2 | Work done for others | services |
| 3 | A catfish farm is in which region? | the Delta |
| 4 | A paper mill is likely in which region? | the Piney Woods |
| 5 | A tour guide provides a... | service |
| 6 | Lumber is a... | good |
| 7 | Trace a product (cotton T-shirt or shrimp dinner) from resource to you. Name at least three producers. | Answers vary. |
| 8 | How does a region's land affect its economy? Give one example. | e.g. Delta soil supports farming jobs. |

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Nov 19 (homework) or as needed

# Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

## Answers

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Four map parts | title, compass rose, key, scale |
| 2 | Lines that run east–west | latitude |
| 3 | Mississippi borders Tennessee to the… | north |
| 4 | the Delta | flat, fertile, crops |
| 5 | Piney Woods | pine forests, timber |
| 6 | Gulf Coast | seafood, shipbuilding, tourism |
| 7 | oil: renewable? | no |
| 8 | forests: renewable? | yes |
| 9 | a doctor's checkup: good or service? | service |

UNIT TEST · Fri Nov 20

# Unit 1 Test — Answer Key

## Answers

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Which map part tells what symbols mean? | map key (legend) |
| 2 | Which direction is between south and west? | southwest |
| 3 | Use the map's scale. About how far is Jackson from Gulfport? (figure) | about 150 miles (accept 130–170) |
| 4 | Which coordinates are closest to Jackson?<br>A. 32° N, 90° W B. 32° S, 90° E C. 90° N, 32° W | A. 32° N, 90° W |
| 5 | Name the states that border Mississippi. | Tennessee, Alabama, Louisiana, Arkansas |
| 6 | What body of water is on Mississippi's southern coast? | Gulf of Mexico |
| 7 | Why do most rivers in Mississippi flow south? | The land slopes down from north to south. |
| 8 | Which kind of map would best show county boundaries?<br>A. physical B. political C. elevation | B. political |
| 9 | Which region has rich alluvial soil? | the Delta |
| 10 | Which region is known for pine forests? | Piney Woods |
| 11 | Name one Gulf Coast job. | e.g. shrimper, shipbuilder, tour guide |
| 12 | Which is a nonrenewable resource?<br>A. timber B. natural gas C. catfish | B. natural gas |
| 13 | Goods or service: delivering mail | service |
| 14 | Name one way to conserve a natural resource. | e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits |
| 15 | Choose two Mississippi regions. Compare their land and explain how the land affects the work people do there. | Rubric: two regions correctly described (1); one similarity (1); one difference (1); clear link between land/resources and jobs (1). |

## Scoring

| Score | What it means / next step |
|---|---|
| 16–18 (85%+) | Mastered. |
| 13–15 | Proficient; review missed skills. |

| Score | What it means / next step |
| --- | --- |
| Below 13 | Reteach and retest. |

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01 Mississippi: Land and Regions


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